

The Consultation Room, Money Edition

Pricing conversations, vendor negotiation, and the client who will not pay

Learning Objectives

- Communicate pricing confidently, without apology or over-justification
- Negotiate transparently with vendors and landlords
- Handle a non-paying client with a firm, professional process
- Explain why a written refund and payment policy prevents most money disputes before they start

Money conversations are consultations too

Every consultation skill this Atelier has taught — clarity, calm confidence, ask-don't-assume — applies directly to conversations about money, a topic many skilled practitioners handle far less confidently than the technical work itself.

Stating a price with confidence

State your price plainly, once, without immediately following it with a justification or apology: "The full bridal package is [price]." A hesitant, over-explained price signals uncertainty a client may read as an invitation to negotiate; a calmly stated price, delivered the same way you would state a safety fact, rarely gets questioned.

Negotiating with vendors and landlords

Approach a lease or supplier negotiation the same way Module Four taught you to approach pricing: know your numbers precisely before the conversation begins, get every agreed term in writing, and never verbally agree to a term you have not had time to actually calculate the impact of.

A Note from Practice

A client's payment fails to process after a completed service, and she promises to "sort it out later" while leaving quickly. Days pass with no follow-up despite polite reminders.

The correct response follows a firm, professional, pre-decided process rather than an improvised, increasingly frustrated one: a clear written reminder stating the amount owed and a specific deadline, a second reminder referencing a stated late-payment policy if the deadline passes, and, if necessary, a final notice before pursuing any further formal collection route available in your region. Consistency and documentation, not anger, resolve this the way a written policy — decided calmly in advance, exactly as Module Nine's bookkeeping habit requires — always performs better than an emotional reaction in the moment.

Key Terms

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[object Object]

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[object Object]

Practical Activity · State the Price

Practice stating three different service prices aloud to a partner, plainly and once, without justification. Ask your partner for honest feedback on whether it sounded confident or apologetic.